

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Mauryan, Buddhist, Jain and Rock-Cut Heritage - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Mauryan, Buddhist, Jain and Rock-Cut Heritage	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01	FOUNDATION — COURT ART AND CATEGORY LIMITS Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yalsha.
02	FOUNDATION — ASHOKAN PILLARS AS COMMUNICATION Evidence chain: Ashokan pillar format - Samath lion capital Qualified
03	FOUNDATION — BARABAR, NAGARJUNI AND THE AJIVIKAS Evidence chain: Barabar and Nagarjuni Qualified use: Use the oldest
04	CORE — STUPA ORIGIN AND ANATOMY Evidence chain: Stupa origin and function - Stupa anatomy Qualified
05	CORE — SANCHI AS A LAYERED MONUMENT UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion.
06	CORE — CHAITYA AND VIHARA A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a
07	CORE — AJANTA'S LANDSCAPE AND PHASES Evidence chain: Ajanta location and phases Qualified use: Answer
08	CORE — ELLORA AND THE KAILASHA MONOLITH Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with
09	CORE — UDAYAGIRI-KHANDAGIRI Evidence chain: Udayagiri-Khandagiri - Hathigumpha source criticism
10	CORE — ELEPHANTA AS A PALIMPSEST Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist
11	CORE — AMARAVATI'S COMPLETE DOSSIER Evidence chain: Amaravati Mahachaitya Qualified use: Connect
12	CORE — JAIN ARCHITECTURE BEYOND CAVES Evidence chain: Jain architectural scales Qualified use: Prepare a
13	CORE SYNTHESIS — ANICONIC AND ICONIC PROGRAMMES Evidence chain: Aniconic to iconic transition Qualified use: Link image
14	CORE SYNTHESIS — INSCRIPTIONS AND EVIDENCE LIMITS Classification: Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight
15	CORE SYNTHESIS — VERIFIED PYQ ANSWER SPINE Classification: Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Court and non-courtly art?

A. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. B. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. C. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. D. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals.

Answer: A. Explanation: Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Court and non-courtly art?

A. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. B. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. C. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. D. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea.

Answer: B. Explanation: Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Court and non-courtly art?

A. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. B. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. C. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. D. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas.

Answer: C. Explanation: Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Court and non-courtly art?

A. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. B. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. C. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. D. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits.

Answer: D. Explanation: Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Ashokan pillar format?

A. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. B. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. C. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. D. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas.

Answer: A. Explanation: Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Ashokan pillar format?

A. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. B. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. C. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. D. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas.

Answer: B. Explanation: Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Ashokan pillar format?

A. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. B. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. C. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. D. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions.

Answer: C. Explanation: Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Ashokan pillar format?

A. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. B. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. C. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. D. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form.

Answer: D. Explanation: Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Sarnath lion capital?

A. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. B. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. C. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. D. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea.

Answer: A. Explanation: The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Sarnath lion capital?

A. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. B. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. C. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. D. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea.

Answer: B. Explanation: The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sarnath lion capital?

A. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. B. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. C. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. D. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry.

Answer: C. Explanation: The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sarnath lion capital?

A. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. B. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. C. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. D. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals.

Answer: D. Explanation: The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Barabar and Nagarjuni?

A. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. B. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. C. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. D. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry.

Answer: A. Explanation: These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Barabar and Nagarjuni?

A. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. B. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. C. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. D. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry.

Answer: B. Explanation: These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Barabar and Nagarjuni?

A. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. B. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. C. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. D. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence.

Answer: C. Explanation: These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Barabar and Nagarjuni?

A. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. B. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. C. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. D. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas.

Answer: D. Explanation: These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Stupa origin and function?

A. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. B. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. C. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. D. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable.

Answer: A. Explanation: A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Stupa origin and function?

A. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. B. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. C. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. D. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions.

Answer: B. Explanation: A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Stupa origin and function?

A. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. B. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. C. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. D. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence.

Answer: C. Explanation: A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Stupa origin and function?

A. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. B. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. C. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. D. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea.

Answer: D. Explanation: A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Stupa anatomy?

A. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. B. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. C. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. D. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions.

Answer: A. Explanation: Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Stupa anatomy?

A. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. B. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. C. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. D. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence.

Answer: B. Explanation: Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Stupa anatomy?

A. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. B. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. C. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. D. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Stupa anatomy?

A. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage. B. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. C. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. D. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry.

Answer: D. Explanation: Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Sanchi's layered patronage?

A. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. B. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. C. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. D. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence.

Answer: A. Explanation: Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Sanchi's layered patronage?

A. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. B. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. C. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. D. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sanchi's layered patronage?

A. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. B. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage. C. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. D. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sanchi's layered patronage?

A. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. B. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. C. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage. D. Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions.

Answer: D. Explanation: Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Chaitya and vihara?

A. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. B. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. C. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. D. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence.

Answer: A. Explanation: A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Chaitya and vihara?

A. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. B. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. C. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. D. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage.

Answer: B. Explanation: A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Chaitya and vihara?

A. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage. B. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. C. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. D. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism.

Answer: C. Explanation: A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Chaitya and vihara?

A. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. B. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage. C. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. D. A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable.

Answer: D. Explanation: A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Ajanta location and phases?

A. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. B. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. C. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. D. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage.

Answer: A. Explanation: Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Ajanta location and phases?

A. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. B. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. C. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. D. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage.

Answer: B. Explanation: Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Ajanta location and phases?

A. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage. B. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. C. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. D. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism.

Answer: C. Explanation: Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Ajanta location and phases?

A. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. B. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. C. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. D. Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence.

Answer: D. Explanation: Ajanta lies in the Waghora gorge in Maharashtra and combines an earlier Satavahana-linked phase with a later Vakataka-era florescence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Ellora's plural complex?

A. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. B. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. C. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. D. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage.

Answer: A. Explanation: Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Ellora's plural complex?

A. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. B. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. C. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage. D. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated.

Answer: B. Explanation: Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Ellora's plural complex?

A. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. B. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. C. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. D. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism.

Answer: C. Explanation: Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Ellora's plural complex?

A. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. B. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. C. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. D. Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence.

Answer: D. Explanation: Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Kailasha monolith?

A. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. B. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage. C. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. D. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism.

Answer: A. Explanation: Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Kailasha monolith?

A. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. B. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. C. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. D. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history.

Answer: B. Explanation: Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Kailasha monolith?

A. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. B. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. C. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. D. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes.

Answer: C. Explanation: Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Kailasha monolith?

A. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. B. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. C. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. D. Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation.

Answer: D. Explanation: Ellora Cave 16 is the monolithic Kailasha temple associated with Rashtrakuta Krishna I, showing temple plan, sculpture and excavation as one operation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Udayagiri-Khandagiri?

A. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage. B. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. C. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. D. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Udayagiri-Khandagiri?

A. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. B. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage. C. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. D. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Udayagiri-Khandagiri?

A. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. B. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. C. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage. D. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Udayagiri-Khandagiri?

A. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. B. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. C. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. D. The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Odisha twin hills preserve a predominantly Jain cave landscape linked to Kharavela and later patronage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Hathigumpha source criticism?

A. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. B. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. C. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. D. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated.

Answer: A. Explanation: Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Hathigumpha source criticism?

A. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. B. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. C. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. D. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes.

Answer: B. Explanation: Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Hathigumpha source criticism?

A. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. B. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. C. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. D. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles.

Answer: C. Explanation: Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Hathigumpha source criticism?

A. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. B. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. C. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. D. Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism.

Answer: D. Explanation: Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Elephanta attribution caution?

A. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. B. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. C. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. D. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history.

Answer: A. Explanation: Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Elephanta attribution caution?

A. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. B. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. C. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. D. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles.

Answer: B. Explanation: Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Elephanta attribution caution?

A. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. B. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. C. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. D. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift.

Answer: C. Explanation: Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Elephanta attribution caution?

A. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. B. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. C. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. D. Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated.

Answer: D. Explanation: Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Amaravati Mahachaitya?

A. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. B. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. C. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. D. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes.

Answer: A. Explanation: Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Amaravati Mahachaitya?

A. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. B. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. C. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. D. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift.

Answer: B. Explanation: Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Amaravati Mahachaitya?

A. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. B. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. C. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. D. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner.

Answer: C. Explanation: Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Amaravati Mahachaitya?

A. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. B. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. C. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. D. Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history.

Answer: D. Explanation: Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Jain architectural scales?

A. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. B. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. C. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. D. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner.

Answer: A. Explanation: Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Jain architectural scales?

A. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. B. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. C. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. D. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner.

Answer: B. Explanation: Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Jain architectural scales?

A. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. B. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. C. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. D. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits.

Answer: C. Explanation: Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Jain architectural scales?

A. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. B. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. C. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. D. Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes.

Answer: D. Explanation: Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Aniconic to iconic transition?

A. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. B. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. C. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. D. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles.

Answer: A. Explanation: Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Aniconic to iconic transition?

A. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. B. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. C. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. D. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance.

Answer: B. Explanation: Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Aniconic to iconic transition?

A. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. B. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. C. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. D. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance.

Answer: C. Explanation: Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Aniconic to iconic transition?

A. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. B. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. C. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. D. Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift.

Answer: D. Explanation: Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Inscriptions as selective evidence?

A. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. B. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. C. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. D. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance.

Answer: A. Explanation: Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Inscriptions as selective evidence?

A. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. B. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. C. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. D. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form.

Answer: B. Explanation: Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Inscriptions as selective evidence?

A. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. B. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. C. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. D. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals.

Answer: C. Explanation: Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Inscriptions as selective evidence?

A. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. B. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. C. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. D. Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles.

Answer: D. Explanation: Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Verified 2020 Mains route?

A. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. B. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits. C. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. D. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance.

Answer: A. Explanation: The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified 2020 Mains route?

A. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. B. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. C. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. D. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits.

Answer: B. Explanation: The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified 2020 Mains route?

A. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. B. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. C. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. D. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals.

Answer: C. Explanation: The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified 2020 Mains route?

A. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. B. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. C. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. D. The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner.

Answer: D. Explanation: The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Official Sanchi linkage?

A. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. B. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. C. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form. D. Mauryan pillars and palaces fit court patronage, while yaksha, terracotta and donor production are often grouped as popular; royal Ajivika caves show the binary's limits.

Answer: A. Explanation: UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Official Sanchi linkage?

A. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. B. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. C. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. D. Many pillars use a monolithic Chunar-sandstone shaft, polished surface and lotus- or bell-shaped capital as a repeatable imperial communication form.

Answer: B. Explanation: UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Official Sanchi linkage?

A. The four lions on an animal-and-wheel abacus became India's National Emblem on 26 January 1950; it must be distinguished from single-animal capitals. B. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. C. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. D. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea.

Answer: C. Explanation: UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Official Sanchi linkage?

A. These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. B. Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. C. A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. D. UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance.

Answer: D. Explanation: UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

The direct owned Mains route is the 2020 GS-I demand on rock-cut architecture as a source for early Indian art and history. Repository routing preserves a neutral rendering rather than claiming locally unavailable verbatim punctuation. Unkeyed or provisionally keyed Prelims routes are not solved.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

7. Exact PYQ application

ANALYSIS: No GS-I Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers directly tests Mauryan/Buddhist/Jain/rock-cut architecture. State this honestly; this topic instead supplies vocabulary (chaitya/vihara, stupa anatomy) and site knowledge (Sanchi, Ajanta, Ellora) that indirectly supports any future Buddhist-art or UNESCO-site question, and supports the sculpture answers in topic 06.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-​I	13	Amaravati Stupa location, scale, sculpture school, and external influence	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-​A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-​A key present locally (Ans-​203;2026-​GS1-​Provisional); key is provisional-​no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/​concept and its likely statement-​level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Amaravati Stupa location, scale, sculpture school, and external influence

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2021, 2023
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 3

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​format	Source status	Owner requirement
2021	Prelims GS-​I	49	Ajanta Caves geographical river gorge location	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/​concept and its likely statement-​level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-​I	42	Stupa origin relic repository commemorative Buddhist structure	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/​concept and its likely statement-​level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-​I	82	Cave shrines Besnagar Bhaja Sittanavasal religious traditions	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/​concept and its likely statement-​level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Ajanta Caves geographical river gorge location
- Stupa origin relic repository commemorative Buddhist structure
- Cave shrines Besnagar Bhaja Sittanavasal religious traditions

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

8. Exact PYQ application

ANALYSIS: No GS-I Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers directly tests this topic. An advanced answer on a related question (e.g. a hypothetical question on religious coexistence in Indian architecture, or on Buddhist art's evolution) should use the layered-patronage method (Section 4) and the aniconic-to-iconic transition as its analytical spine, cross-referencing topic 06 for the sculptural detail of that transition.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2020
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​format	Source status	Owner requirement
2020	GS-​#8203;I	1	Rock-​cut architecture as a source for early Indian art and history	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/​examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Rock-cut architecture as a source for early Indian art and history

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 GS-I

Demand: Rock-cut architecture as a source for early Indian art and history

Status: Verified neutral routed demand; not claimed as verbatim.

Model solution: Define rock-cut evidence, then use Barabar for Ajivika royal patronage, chaitya-vihara plans for practice, Sanchi or Ellora for accretion, and Hathigumpha for inscriptional limits; conclude that stone over-represents durable endowment.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 GS-I", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Define rock-cut evidence, then use Barabar for Ajivika royal patronage, chaitya-vihara plans for practice, Sanchi or Ellora for accretion, and Hathigumpha for inscriptional limits; conclude that stone over-represents durable endowment.

Qualification: Bound the claim by period, region, medium, patronage and evidence status; do not convert similarity into direct descent or a commissioned representation into a social census.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 GS-I", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Discuss rock-cut architecture as a source for early Indian art and history. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Rock-cut sites preserve patronage, liturgical plan, technique, inscriptions and sectarian change, but privilege durable elite endowment and require source criticism.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas.
- A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable.
- Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence.
- Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism.
- Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles.
- The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner.

Qualified conclusion: Rock-cut sites preserve patronage, liturgical plan, technique, inscriptions and sectarian change, but privilege durable elite endowment and require source criticism.

Demand decoding: The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on "Discuss rock-cut architecture as a source for early Indian art and history. Answer in about...", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Rock-cut sites preserve patronage, liturgical plan, technique, inscriptions and sectarian change, but privilege durable elite endowment and require source criticism.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** The routed 2020 GS-I demand treats rock-cut architecture as evidence for early Indian art and history and is answerable from the Core owner. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage

or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Rock-cut sites preserve patronage, liturgical plan, technique, inscriptions and sectarian change, but privilege durable elite endowment and require source criticism.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise three named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Discuss rock-cut architecture as a source for early Indian art and history. Answer in about...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish a chaitya from a vihara and explain why the distinction matters. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Function drives form: congregational worship and stupa focus differ from monastic residence, allowing plans to reconstruct religious practice cautiously.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable.

Qualified conclusion: Function drives form: congregational worship and stupa focus differ from monastic residence, allowing plans to reconstruct religious practice cautiously.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Distinguish a chaitya from a vihara and explain why the distinction matters. Answer in about...”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Function drives form: congregational worship and stupa focus differ from monastic residence, allowing plans to reconstruct religious practice cautiously.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Function drives form: congregational worship and stupa focus differ from monastic residence, allowing plans to reconstruct religious practice cautiously.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise three named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Distinguish a chaitya from a vihara and explain why the distinction matters. Answer in about...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Trace the evolution of the Buddhist stupa through Sanchi. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The relic mound remained the core while railings, paths, gateways, sculpture and shrines accumulated through successive patronage layers.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea.
- Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry.
- Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions.
- UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance.

Qualified conclusion: The relic mound remained the core while railings, paths, gateways, sculpture and shrines accumulated through successive patronage layers.

Demand decoding: The directive **trace** requires a direct position on "Trace the evolution of the Buddhist stupa through Sanchi. Answer in about 250 words.", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The relic mound remained the core while railings, paths, gateways, sculpture and shrines accumulated through successive patronage layers.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Anda, medhi, vedika, pradakshina patha, harmika, chhatra and torana organise relic, boundary, movement, honour and entry. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Sanchi Stupa 1 grew from an Ashokan brick core through Sunga enlargement and stone facing, Satavahana-period gateways and Gupta additions. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** UNESCO's official Sanchi page describes the site's long accretion, aniconic art, stupa anatomy and continuing sacred significance. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: The relic mound remained the core while railings, paths, gateways, sculpture and shrines accumulated through successive patronage layers.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Trace the evolution of the Buddhist stupa through Sanchi. Answer in about 250 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: How should inscriptions be used to interpret early monuments? Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Inscriptions can name patrons, grants and claims, but must be read for genre, eulogy and silence, as Hathigumpha demonstrates.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism.
- Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles.

Qualified conclusion: Inscriptions can name patrons, grants and claims, but must be read for genre, eulogy and silence, as Hathigumpha demonstrates.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “How should inscriptions be used to interpret early monuments? Answer in about 250 words.”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Inscriptions can name patrons, grants and claims, but must be read for genre, eulogy and silence, as Hathigumpha demonstrates.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Kharavela's Prakrit Brahmi inscription is a major narrative source but a commemorative royal text whose selections and omissions require criticism. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Donor and royal inscriptions can identify patrons and acts, yet eulogy and silence prevent treating them as neutral chronicles. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Inscriptions can name patrons, grants and claims, but must be read for genre, eulogy and silence, as Hathigumpha demonstrates.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “How should inscriptions be used to interpret early monuments? Answer in about 250 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Examine religious plurality and sacred-site continuity in Indian rock-cut heritage. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Barabar's Ajivika dedication, Ellora's overlapping Buddhist-Hindu-Jain phases and Elephanta's palimpsest show recurring sacred geographies, not one planned pluralist project.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas.
- Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence.
- Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated.
- Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes.

Qualified conclusion: Barabar's Ajivika dedication, Ellora's overlapping Buddhist-Hindu-Jain phases and Elephanta's palimpsest show recurring sacred geographies, not one planned pluralist project.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine religious plurality and sacred-site continuity in Indian rock-cut heritage. Answer in...", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Barabar's Ajivika dedication, Ellora's overlapping Buddhist-Hindu-Jain phases and Elephanta's palimpsest show recurring sacred geographies, not one planned pluralist project.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** These third-century BCE Bihar caves are the oldest known Indian rock-cut architecture and were dedicated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to the Ajivikas. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Ellora's thirty-four caves comprise Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain groups with overlapping phases rather than a perfectly clean sequence. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Elephanta is a Shaiva-dominant island cave complex with Buddhist remains; precise dynastic attribution remains debated. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Barabar's Ajivika dedication, Ellora's overlapping Buddhist-Hindu-Jain phases and Elephanta's palimpsest show recurring sacred geographies, not one planned pluralist project.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise six to eight named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Examine religious plurality and sacred-site continuity in Indian rock-cut heritage. Answer in...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Compare Buddhist and Jain architectural programmes from caves to structural monuments. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Both used regional building idioms, but programme and ritual differentiated chaitya-vihara-stupa complexes from Jain cave, temple, colossus and pilgrimage-hill forms.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea.
- A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable.
- Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history.
- Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes.
- Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift.

Qualified conclusion: Both used regional building idioms, but programme and ritual differentiated chaitya-vihara-stupa complexes from Jain cave, temple, colossus and pilgrimage-hill forms.

Demand decoding: The directive **compare** requires a direct position on “Compare Buddhist and Jain architectural programmes from caves to structural monuments. Answer...”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Both used regional building idioms, but programme and ritual differentiated chaitya-vihara-stupa complexes from Jain cave, temple, colossus and pilgrimage-hill forms.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A stupa is a votive or commemorative relic repository with pre-Buddhist antecedents, so it is not an exclusively Buddhist architectural idea. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall commonly terminating in a stupa; a vihara is monastic residence, and the two terms are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Amaravati links a relic monument, Satavahana-period enlargement, limestone sculpture, inscriptions, ayaka pillars and colonial dispersal history. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Jain heritage ranges from Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora caves to marble or stone temples, monolithic ritual images and hill pilgrimage landscapes. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Early Buddhist art represented the Buddha through symbols, while later figural images changed shrine programmes; architecture records but does not alone explain the shift. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Both used regional building idioms, but programme and ritual differentiated chaitya-vihara-stupa complexes from Jain cave, temple, colossus and pilgrimage-hill forms.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise six to eight named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Compare Buddhist and Jain architectural programmes from caves to structural monuments. Answer...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.